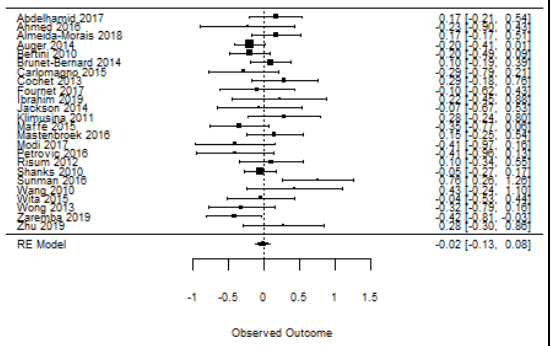
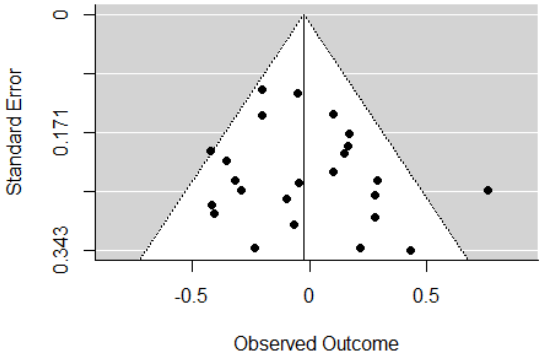
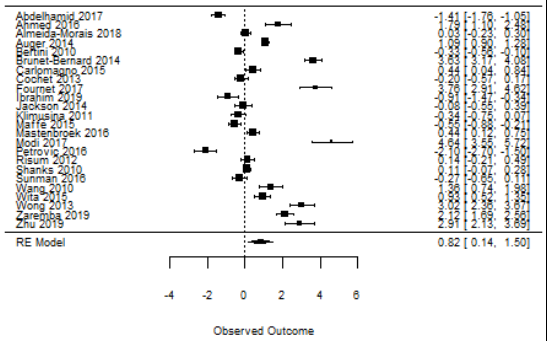
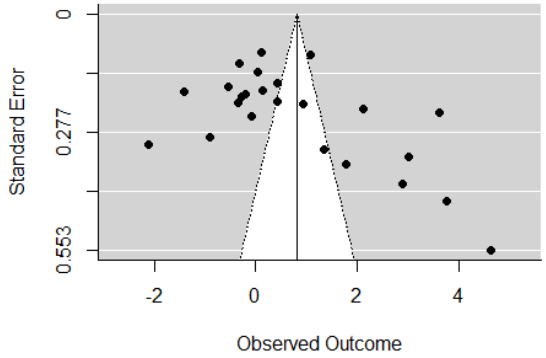
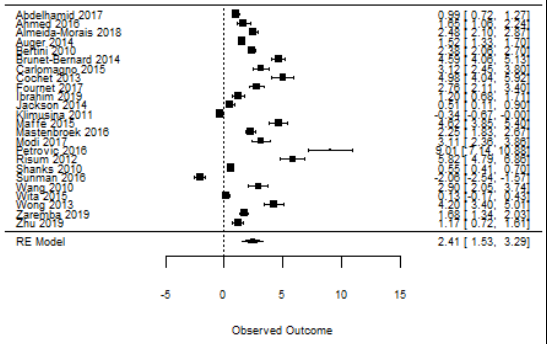
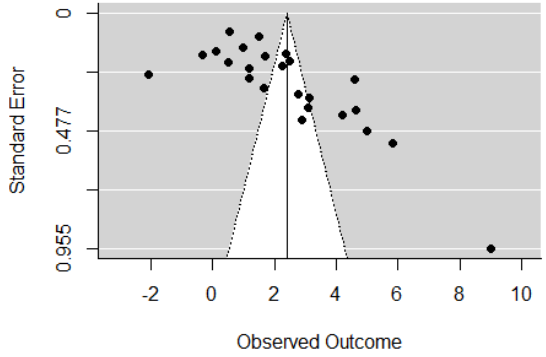
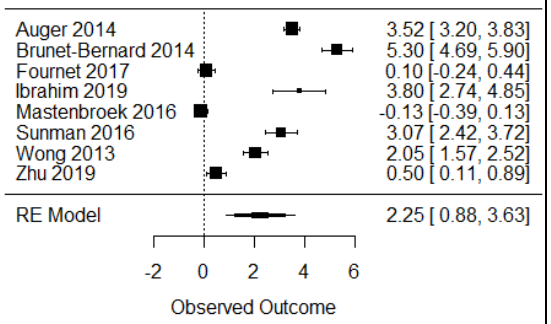
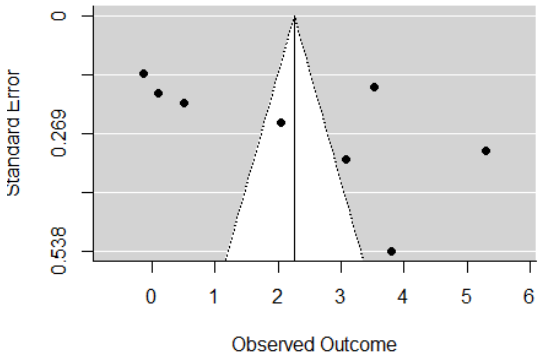
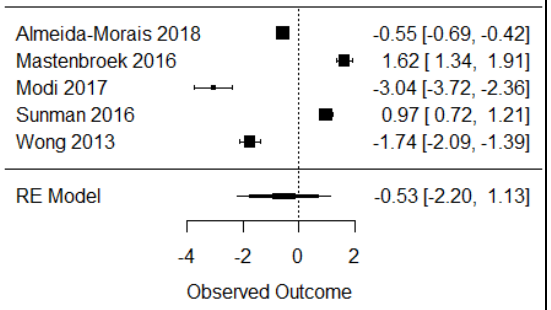
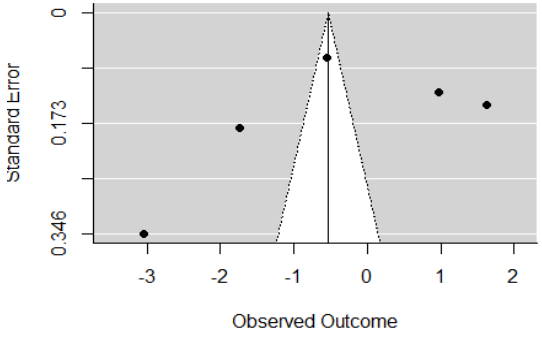
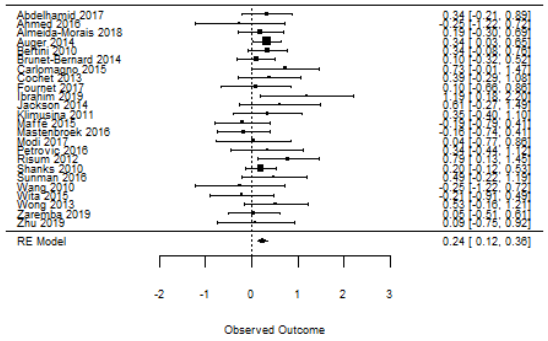
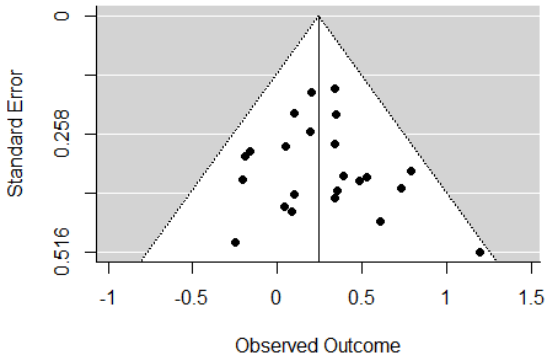
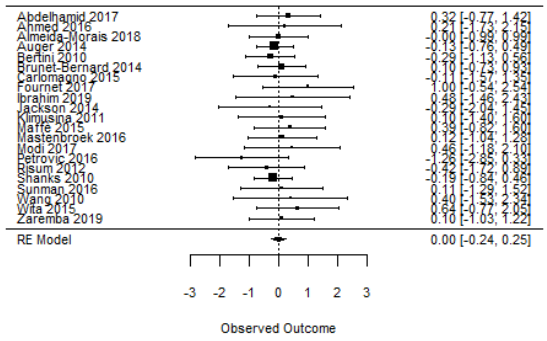
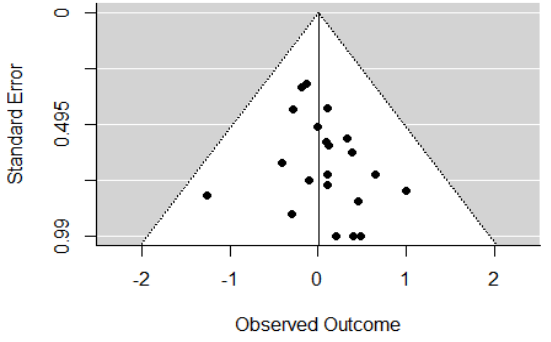
Appendix III

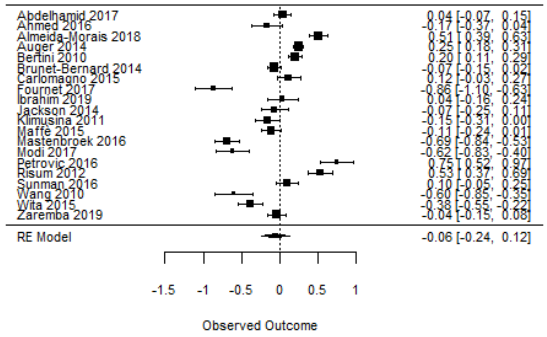
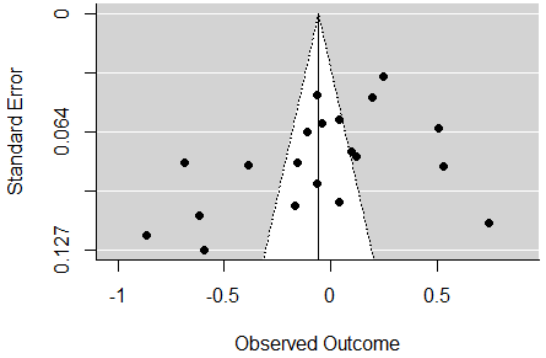
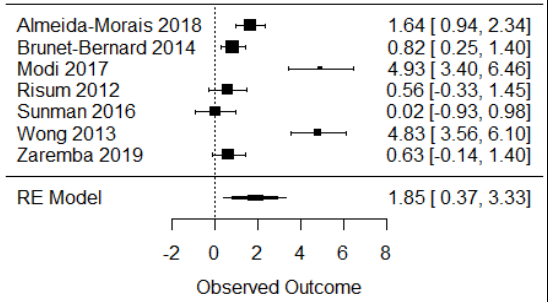
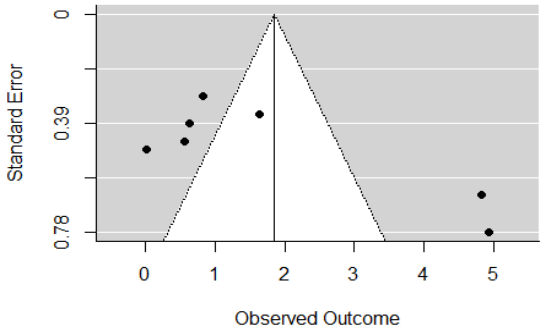
Table - Results from meta-analyses performed for each one of the 13 variables considered, which were the basis of the forest plot represented on figure 1 of the results section

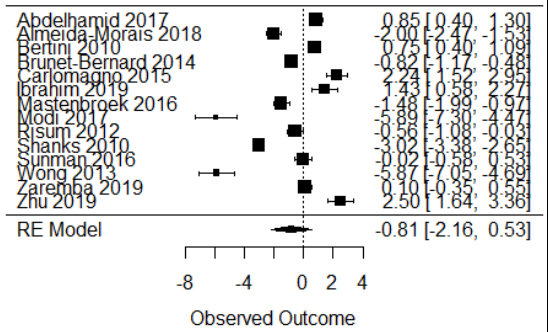
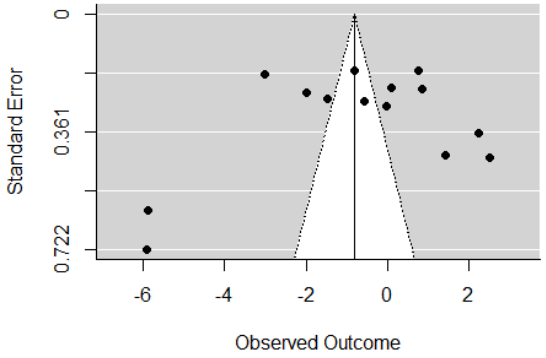
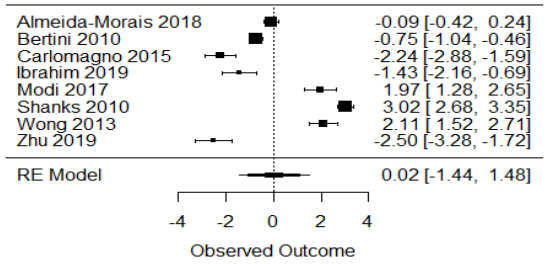
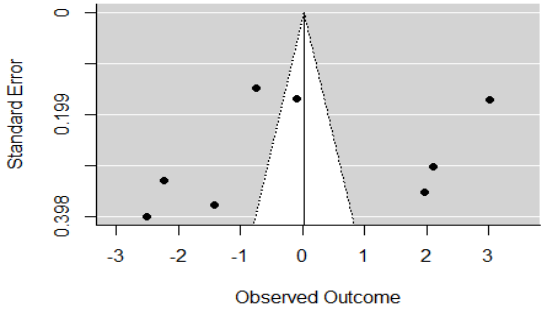
Variable	Forest Plot	Funnel Plot	**Egger regression: precision coefficient (p); Adj.R2**	**Begg Mazumdar test: τ Kendal (p)**
Age I^2 = 36.8% Std. Effect: -0.02 95%CI: -0.13 to 0.08 p = 0.665			-0.025 (0.504); 0.021	0.080 (0.606)

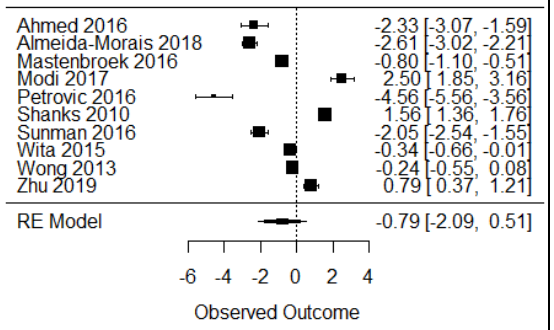
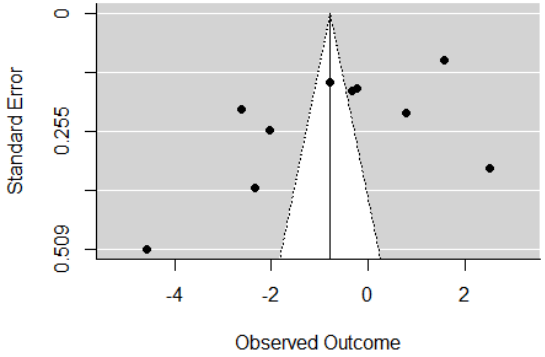
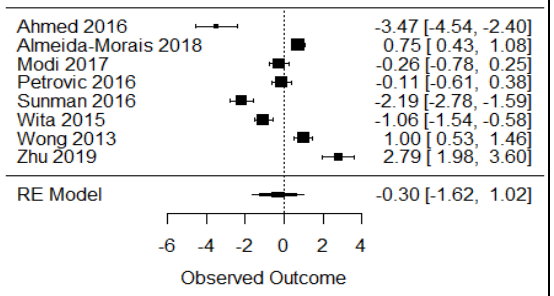
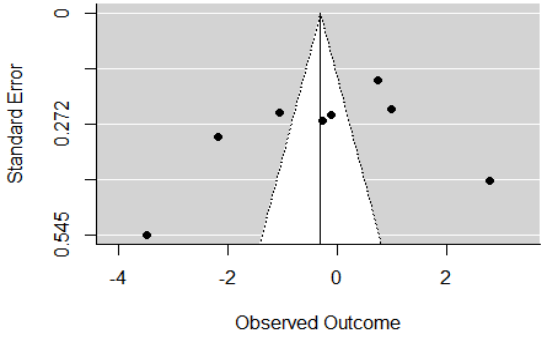
Variable	Forest Plot	Funnel Plot	Egger regression: precision coefficient (p); Adj.R2	Begg Mazumdar test: τ Kendal (p)
% Male I^2 = 98.8% Std. Effect: 0.82 95%CI: 0.14 to 1.50 p = 0.018			-0.030 (0.046); 0.132 Higher effect size for studies with smaller precision	0.348 (0.017) Higher effect size for studies with higher variability (in spite of p < 0.05, correlation is despicable)
% Non-ischemic aetiology I^2 = 99.2% Std. Effect: 2.41 95%CI: 1.53 to 3.29 p < 0.001			-0.046 (0.004); 0.284 Higher effect size for studies with smaller precision	0.601 (< 0.001) Higher effect size for studies with higher variability (moderate correlation)

Variable	Forest Plot	Funnel Plot	Egger regression: precision coefficient (p); Adj.R2	Begg Mazumdar test: τ Kendal (p)
% Left branch block I^2 = 98.9% Std. Effect: 2.25 95%CI: -0.88 to 3.63 p = 0.013			-0.072 (0.063); 0.373	0.571 (0.061)
% Atrial Fibrillation I^2 = 99.5% Std. Effect: -0.53 95%CI: -2.20 to 1.13 p = 0.530			0.192 (0.484); 0.174	-0.400 (0.483)

Variable	Forest Plot	Funnel Plot	Egger regression: precision coefficient (p); Adj.R2	Begg Mazumdar test: τ Kendal (p)
QRS Time (ms) I^2 = 0.1% Std. Effect: 0.24 95%CI: 0.13 to 0.36 p < 0.001			-0.021 (0.745); 0.005	-0.033 (0.843)
Ejection fraction (%) I^2 = 0.0% Std. Effect: 0.004 95%CI: -0.24 to 0.25 p = 0.976			-0.167 (0.329); 0.0001	0.282 (0.080)

Variable	Forest Plot	Funnel Plot	Egger regression: precision coefficient (p); Adj.R2	Begg Mazumdar test: τ Kendal (p)
LVESV (ml) I^2 = 97.3% Std. Effect: -0.06 95%CI: -0.23 to 0.14 p = 0.537			0.026 (0.140); 0.068	-0.326 (0.046) Higher effect size for studies with higher variability (in spite of p < 0.05, correlation is despicable)
% NYHA II I^2 = 95.2% Std. Effect: 1.85 95%CI: 0.37 to 3.33 p = 0.014			-1.96 (0.083); 0.380	0.143 (0.773)

Variable	Forest Plot	Funnel Plot	Egger regression: precision coefficient (p); Adj.R2	Begg Mazumdar test: τ Kendal (p)
% NYHA III I^2 = 99.0% Std. Effect: -0.81 95%CI: -2.16 to 0.53 p = 0.235			0.436 (0.414); 0.017	0.055 (0.830)
% NYHA IV I^2 = 98.8% Std. Effect: 0.03 95%CI: -1.44 to 1.49 p = 0.976			0.345 (0.493); 0.082	-0.357 (0.275)

Variable	Forest Plot	Funnel Plot	Egger regression: precision coefficient (p); Adj.R2	Begg Mazumdar test: τ Kendal (p)
% Diabetes I^2 = 99.2% Std. Effect: -0.79 95%CI: -2.09 to 0.51 p = 0.235			0.452 (0.147); 0.149	-0.333 (0.216)
% HT I^2 = 98.1% Std. Effect: -0.30 95%CI: -1.62 to 1.02 p = 0.652			0.505 (0.427); 0.108	-0.357 (0.275)